

AuthorsLab Prosumer Bracket Pricing

Research Report V1

AL-PC-PBR-001 · 2026-07-28 · AL Pricing Chat · Closes the open question named in AL-SIS-PRR-001 §7 (prosumer bracket around £19)

Method: five parallel research agents, one per product; primary source = official pricing page by direct fetch 2026-07-28 (**HIGH**), cross-checked against ≥1 independent 2025–26 source (**MEDIUM** where the official page was silent). Discrepancies carried explicitly in §5. All prices USD as displayed; GBP conversion at the V1 convention (£19 ≈ \$24).

1 · Headline answer

The bracket does not actually sell at £19. The two AI-adjacent tools (ProWritingAid, Grammarly) advertise annual-equivalent prices of **\$10–12/mo** (~£8–10) while charging **\$30–36/mo** billed monthly; the craft tools (Scrivener \$59.99, Atticus \$147) are one-time; NovelCrafter tops out at \$20/mo *with AI cost externalized to the user's own API key*. So the £19 flagship is **above every neighbour's annual-effective price and below every neighbour's monthly-billed price**.

Two consequences: (a) the billing basis of "£19" must be decided explicitly — the bracket's universal pattern is a high monthly anchor with a 60–67% annual discount; (b) £19 cannot be justified on parity with any single neighbour — it holds only on scope (five journey phases vs single-function tools), which keeps Sudowrite Pro (\$22–29) the true reference point, exactly as AL-SIS-PRR-001 §6 placed it.

2 · Verified pricing (fetched 2026-07-28; HIGH confidence unless noted)

Product	Model	Price	AI metering
ProWritingAid	Hybrid: feature-gate at Free→Premium, capacity-metered above	Premium \$30/mo or \$120/yr (\$10/mo, "save 67%") · Premium Pro \$36/mo or \$144/yr (\$12/mo) · Lifetime \$399 / \$699	AI "Sparks" 3/5/50 per day by tier; Chapter Critique 1/day (Premium), 3/day (Pro) ; separate purchasable "Story Credits" (tier discounts 40%/65%); free tier capped 500 words
Grammarly (now under Superhuman platform branding)	Feature-gated tiers + monthly prompt caps	Pro \$12/mo annual-billed (\$144 upfront) · \$30/mo monthly (MEDIUM, 2 sources) · Free \$0	Generative prompts 100/mo free, 2,000/mo Pro (raised from 1,000), unlimited Enterprise. Business tier discontinued — Pro serves up to 149 seats
NovelCrafter	Feature-gated subscription + BYOK (bring your own key)	Scribe \$4 · Hobbyist \$8 (first AI tier) · Artisan \$14 · Specialist \$20 /mo; annual = 2 months off	No AI included at any price — user pays own OpenAI/Anthropic/OpenRouter token bill on top; subscription buys platform only
Scrivener	One-time perpetual, per platform	\$59.99 macOS or Windows · \$23.99 iOS · bundle \$95.98 (MEDIUM) · crossgrade \$37.95 · edu –15%	None; no AI, no subscription ("we don't want to add yet another monthly bill" — official). Scrivener 4 neither released nor announced
Atticus	One-time perpetual, single SKU	\$147 , "no monthly fees, forever"; 30-day refund; lifetime updates	None; no AI features on site or 2024–26 changelog

3 · Shape lessons for AuthorsLab

- Nobody sells unmetered AI on a flat prosumer fee.** The bracket's three answers: daily/monthly allowances (ProWritingAid, Grammarly), BYOK (NovelCrafter), or no AI (Scrivener, Atticus). The credit-allowance architecture in the stress-test frame is confirmed as bracket-standard — there is no competitor precedent for "unlimited deep analysis" at any writer-tier price. (**HIGH**)
- The annual-discount spread is the bracket's biggest lever.** PWA 67% (\$360→\$120), Grammarly 60% (\$360→\$144), NovelCrafter ~17% (2 months). The "£19" decision is really two decisions: the monthly anchor and the annual effective price. A £19 monthly / ~£12–13-effective annual structure would sit dead-centre in bracket norms. (**HIGH**)

3. ProWritingAid's Chapter Critique is the closest metered comparable to an AL analysis pass: 1/day at \$10–30/mo, 3/day at \$12–36/mo. Any AL deep-analysis credit allowance can be benchmarked directly against this when sizing tiers — and lmo_ledger will tell us what each pass actually costs, which PWA's public pricing cannot. (*HIGH*)

4. The one-time band is \$59.99–\$147 (plus Vellum \$249.99, prior report). AL's retained per-book pass at \$149–299 sits at/above the top of the band — defensible on journey scope, but \$299 is double Atticus; the funnel-pass price point deserves its own test rather than inheriting the current \$299. (*HIGH for band; SYNTHESIS for implication*)

5. Lifetime SKUs exist here (PWA \$399/\$699; Scrivener/Atticus are lifetime by construction) and writers demonstrably like them — but for a metered-COGS product a lifetime SKU is an unhedged liability; PWA hedges by keeping AI daily-capped even for lifetime holders. If AL ever offers lifetime, the same hedge is mandatory. (*MEDIUM/SYNTHESIS*)

6. No per-seat mid-market exists in the bracket. Grammarly just folded Business into Pro; nothing sits between prosumer tiers and enterprise sales. Confirms the imprint SKU is a separate motion priced against Consonance/Hederis, not an extension of writer tiers. (*HIGH*)

7. Price-rise precedent: PWA raised Premium ~52% (\$79→\$120/yr) and introduced a higher tier (*MEDIUM*, secondary only); Scrivener rose \$49→\$59.99 in 2022; Grammarly doubled Pro's prompt cap instead of cutting price. Raising later is bracket-normal; the Cursor lesson (grandfather deliberately) still governs *how*. (*MEDIUM*)

4 · Positioning read for the £19 flagship

£19/mo monthly-billed (~\$24) is: above PWA Premium annual (\$10) and Grammarly Pro annual (\$12); below PWA/Grammarly monthly (\$30); above NovelCrafter's top tier (\$20) — but NovelCrafter + typical BYOK token spend lands a heavy AI user at a comparable or higher all-in cost with none of the metering predictability.

The honest comparison set for a five-phase platform remains Sudowrite (\$10–44 effective) + one craft tool + one polish tool: a committed indie replicating AL's scope today stacks roughly Sudowrite Pro (\$22) + Scrivener (~\$2/mo amortised) + PWA Premium (\$10) ≈ **\$34/mo equivalent** — the strongest single argument that £19–24 all-in is priced *under* the DIY stack. (*SYNTHESIS — use in deck.*)

5 · Discrepancies & caveats (carried honestly)

- **atticus.tech ≠ atticus.io.** A 2025 "Atticus moves to subscription" announcement belongs to an unrelated legal-tech product. Any future claim that Atticus abandoned one-time pricing should be checked against this false positive. (*HIGH*)
- Scrivener desktop prices are JS-rendered on the store page; \$59.99 was confirmed on two *other* official L&L pages. Bundle \$95.98 and edu \$50.99 are secondary-source (*MEDIUM*). GBP pricing unverified — L&L quotes USD.
- Grammarly monthly-billed \$30 and quarterly \$20/mo are secondary-source (two agreeing, *MEDIUM*); the official page shows only the \$12 annual rate. A demandsage "20% off" coupon was not verified and is likely affiliate.
- NovelCrafter exact annual dollar figures are secondary (*MEDIUM*) though the official "2 months off" mechanism is *HIGH* and the figures match it.
- One free-tier detail conflict (PWA report runs/day) resolved in favour of the official page.
- All prices are US-session USD; regional/VAT treatment unobserved for all five. Vendor prices can change; re-verify before the deck ships.

6 · Open questions passed forward

Does the flagship's analysis-credit allowance beat PWA's 1/day Chapter Critique on perceived generosity once lmo_ledger tells us unit cost? Should the funnel pass reprice below \$299 now that the one-time band is verified at \$59.99–\$147? Both belong in the financial model + options paper, not here.